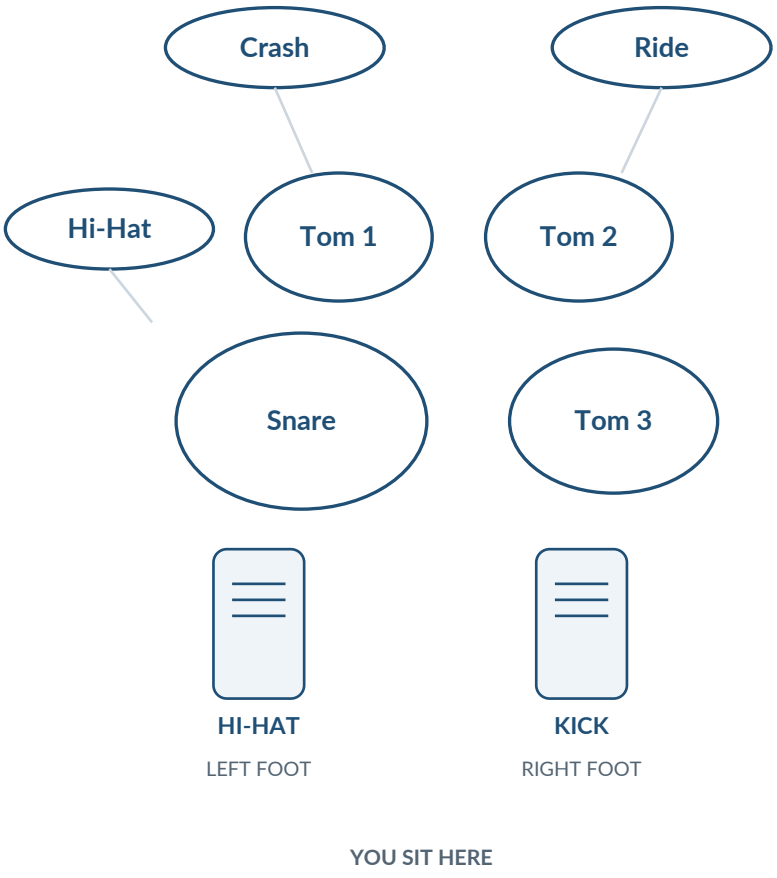
START HERE

YOUR ELECTRONIC DRUM KIT

5 drum sounds | 3 cymbals | 2 pedals | Right-handed player view

Start with 15-20 minutes a day. Follow SEE > COUNT > CLAP > PLAY > GROOVE. Repeat a day whenever you need more time.



Right hand
Hi-Hat, Ride or Crash

Left hand
Snare backbeats

Right foot
Kick pedal

Left foot
Keep the Hi-Hat closed

COUNT SOUNDS, NOT JUST PADS

Snare + 3 Toms + pedal-triggered Kick = 5 drum sounds. The Hi-Hat pedal is a controller, not a sixth drum.

Your pad positions may vary. Match the sound labels first. This course does not require a kick tower, half-open hi-hat control, or a foot-chick pattern.

R = right hand; L = left hand. A left-handed setup can mirror the limb assignments. Use a comfortable seat height and listening level.

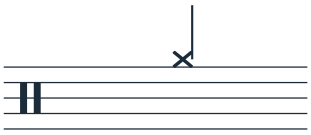
NOTATION REFERENCE

READ THE FIVE-LINE DRUM STAFF

Use this key throughout the book. Other publications may use different drum positions.

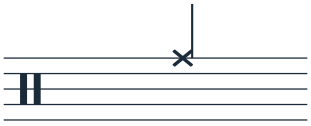
X noteheads are cymbals; **oval noteheads** are drums. In this edition, hand notes have up-stems and kick notes have down-stems. Notes aligned vertically are played together.

HH | Hi-Hat



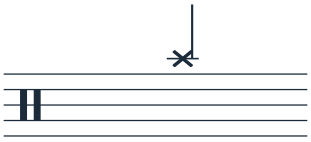
Above top line

RD | Ride
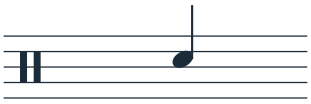


Top line

CR | Crash



Upper ledger line

SN | Snare
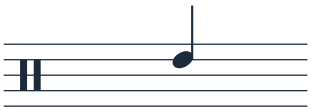


2nd space from top

T1 | Tom 1



Top space

T2 | Tom 2
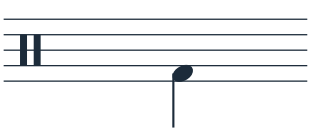


2nd line from top

T3 | Tom 3



2nd space from bottom

KD | Kick



Bottom space

READING TIME

Quarter note



1 beat

Two eighth notes



1 beat total

Quarter rest



1 silent beat

EVERY BAR HAS FOUR BEATS

4/4 = four quarter-note beats. When two voices appear, notes and rests add up to four beats in EACH voice, not eight beats in total.

Count quarters: **1 2 3 4**. Count eighths: **1 & 2 & 3 & 4 &**. A rest in one voice does not stop the other voice. A bar line closes the measure.

DAY 1 | PAGE A | LEARN

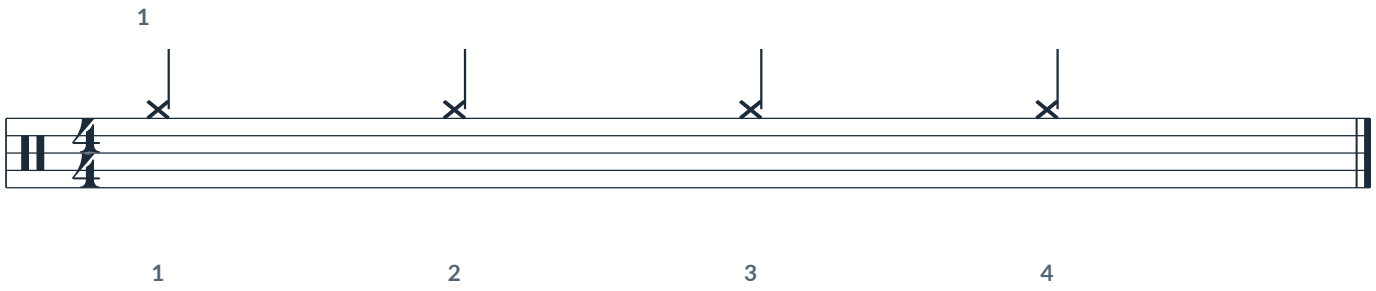
DAY 1 - FIND YOUR BEAT

Four counts. Four evenly spaced hits.

TODAY'S GOAL

Play one hi-hat note on each count: 1, 2, 3, 4.

CORE PATTERN



4/4 time means four quarter-note beats in each bar. At 60 BPM, one click equals one beat.

SEE > COUNT > CLAP > PLAY > GROOVE

1. **SEE** Find the four X-shaped hi-hat notes above the staff.
2. **COUNT** Say 1, 2, 3, 4 evenly. The next count 1 begins a new bar.
3. **CLAP** Clap once per click before you pick up the sticks.
4. **PLAY** Use your right hand on the hi-hat; hold the hi-hat pedal closed with your left foot.
5. **GROOVE** Repeat the bar. Leave the snare and kick silent today.

LISTEN FOR THIS

Listen for equal gaps between hits. Use small, relaxed strokes instead of playing harder.

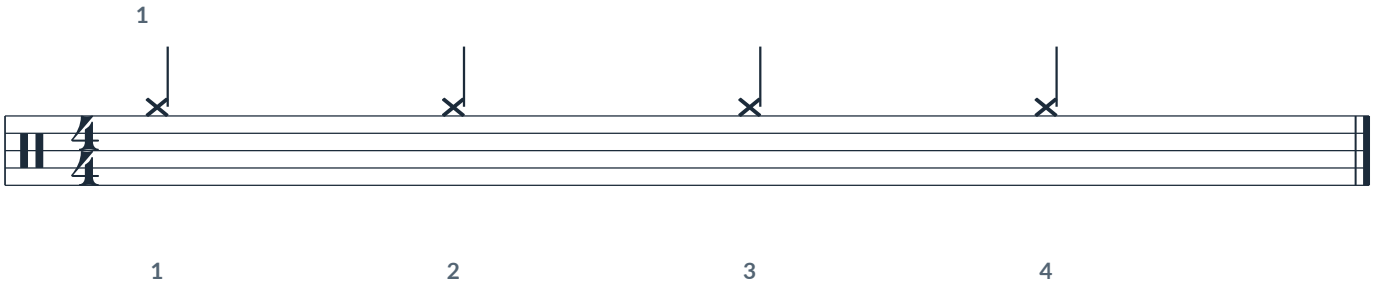
DAILY TARGET At 60 BPM, play 16 continuous bars. Begin after one counted bar.

DAY 1 | PAGE B | PRACTICE

DAY 1 - PUT IT INTO PRACTICE

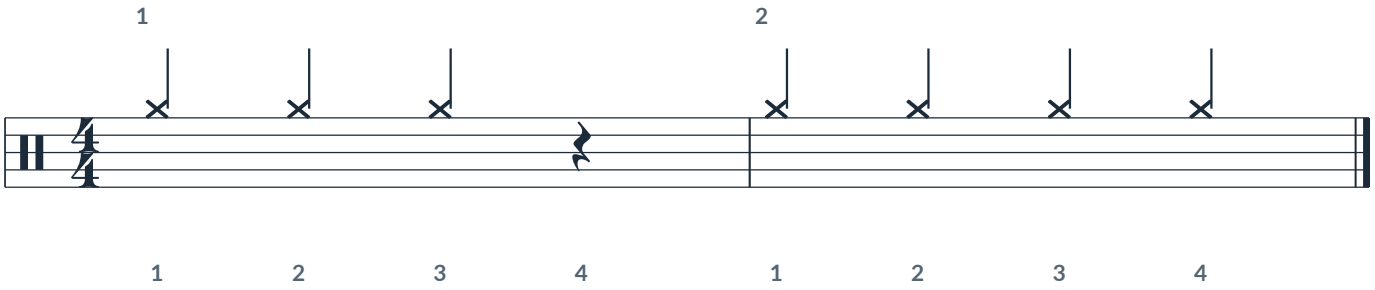
Start slowly. A clean repetition matters more than a higher tempo.

EXERCISE A | KEEP FOUR STEADY HITS



Repeat this one-bar pattern 8 times. Count every beat out loud.

EXERCISE B | KEEP COUNTING THROUGH SILENCE



Bar 1: rest on beat 4. Bar 2: return on beat 1. Repeat the pair 4 times.

COMMON TRAP / QUICK FIX

The quarter rest lasts one beat. Do not hit on it, but keep saying the number.

PRACTICE RECORD

Date: _____ Tempo: _____ BPM Clean bars: _____

At 60 BPM, play 16 continuous bars. Begin after one counted bar.

DAY 2 | PAGE A | LEARN

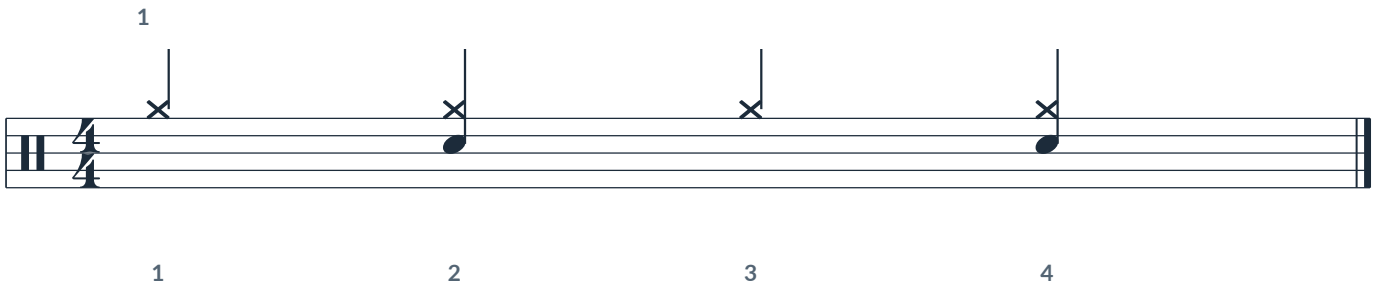
DAY 2 - FEEL THE BACKBEAT

Keep the pulse in one hand; add the backbeat with the other.

TODAY'S GOAL

Keep hi-hat quarter notes and add snare on beats 2 and 4.

CORE PATTERN



The hi-hat and snare noteheads on counts 2 and 4 share a stem: strike both together.

SEE > COUNT > CLAP > PLAY > GROOVE

1. **SEE** Find the snare noteheads in the second space from the top.
2. **COUNT** Say 1, 2, 3, 4; emphasize the words 2 and 4 without speeding up.
3. **CLAP** Clap only on 2 and 4 while keeping all four counts.
4. **PLAY** Right hand: hi-hat every beat. Left hand: snare on 2 and 4. No kick yet.
5. **GROOVE** Listen for the hi-hat and snare landing together on the backbeats.

LISTEN FOR THIS

Do not let the right hand stop when the left hand plays. Keep the hi-hat soft and even.
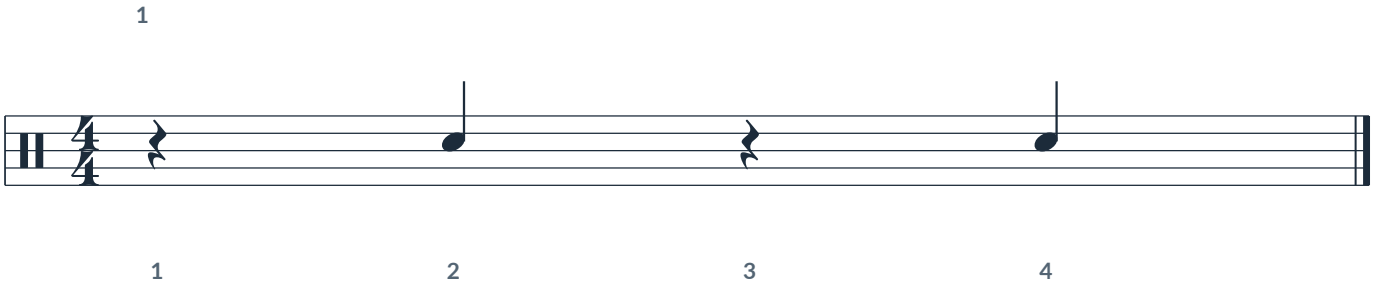
DAILY TARGET At 60 BPM, play 8 clean bars with the snare consistently on 2 and 4.

DAY 2 | PAGE B | PRACTICE

DAY 2 - PUT IT INTO PRACTICE

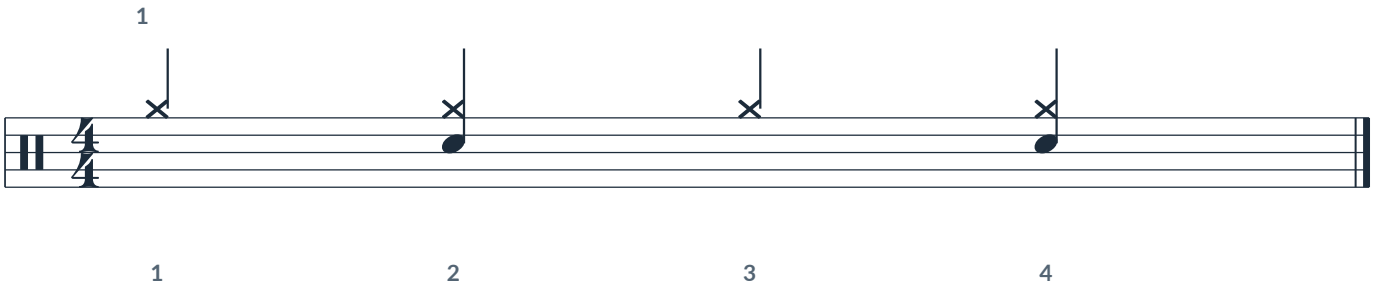
Start slowly. A clean repetition matters more than a higher tempo.

EXERCISE A | ISOLATE THE SNARE



Play only the snare. Beats 1 and 3 are quarter rests; keep counting.

EXERCISE B | COMBINE BOTH HANDS



Add the hi-hat on all four beats. Repeat 8 bars without pausing.

COMMON TRAP / QUICK FIX

A shared stem can join different noteheads. It still represents one moment in time.

PRACTICE RECORD

Date: _____ Tempo: _____ BPM Clean bars: _____

At 60 BPM, play 8 clean bars with the snare consistently on 2 and 4.

DAY 3 | PAGE A | LEARN

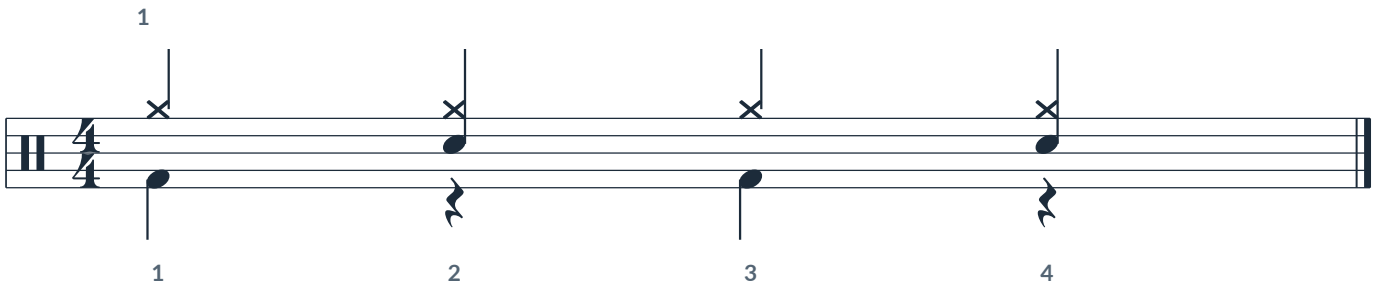
DAY 3 - BUILD YOUR GROOVE

Two hands and one foot, working together.

TODAY'S GOAL

Add kick on beats 1 and 3 while keeping the Day 2 hand pattern.

CORE PATTERN



Up-stems show the hands. Down-stems show the kick foot. Read them at the same time.

SEE > COUNT > CLAP > PLAY > GROOVE

1. **SEE** Find the low kick noteheads on beats 1 and 3.
2. **COUNT** Say 1, 2, 3, 4 and tap your right foot on 1 and 3.
3. **CLAP** Clap on 2 and 4 while your right foot taps on 1 and 3.
4. **PLAY** First combine hi-hat and kick; then add the left-hand snare.
5. **GROOVE** Keep the left foot holding the hi-hat closed; do not pump that pedal.

LISTEN FOR THIS

The kick should land with the hi-hat, not just before or after it. Simplify to Exercise A if needed.

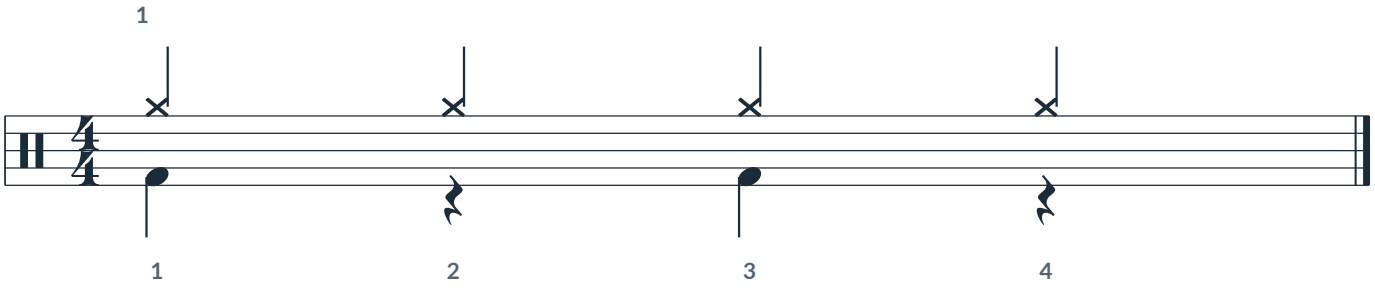
DAILY TARGET Play 16 clean bars at 60 BPM. Try 65-70 BPM only after the pattern is steady.

DAY 3 | PAGE B | PRACTICE

DAY 3 - PUT IT INTO PRACTICE

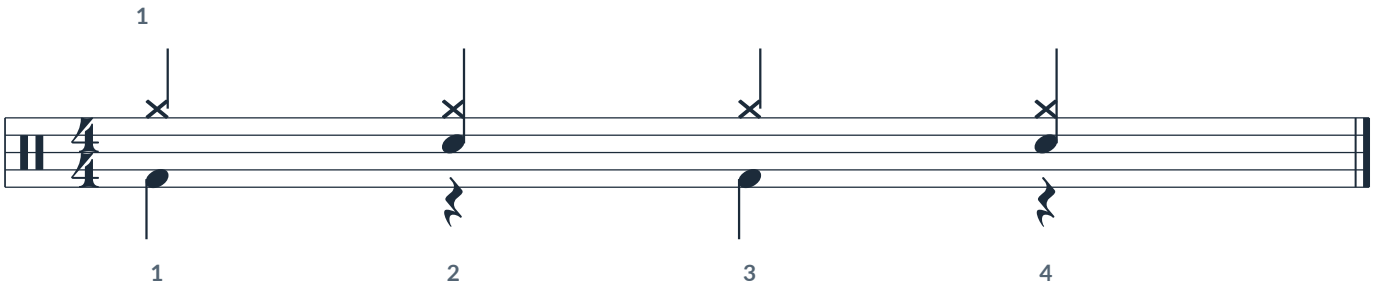
Start slowly. A clean repetition matters more than a higher tempo.

EXERCISE A | RIGHT HAND + RIGHT FOOT



Hi-hat on every beat. Kick on 1 and 3. Keep the snare silent.

EXERCISE B | ADD THE LEFT HAND



Add snare on 2 and 4 without changing the hi-hat or kick pattern.

COMMON TRAP / QUICK FIX

A rest in the lower voice means no kick at that moment; your hands may still play.

PRACTICE RECORD

Date: _____ Tempo: _____ BPM Clean bars: _____

Play 16 clean bars at 60 BPM. Try 65-70 BPM only after the pattern is steady.

DAY 4 | PAGE A | LEARN

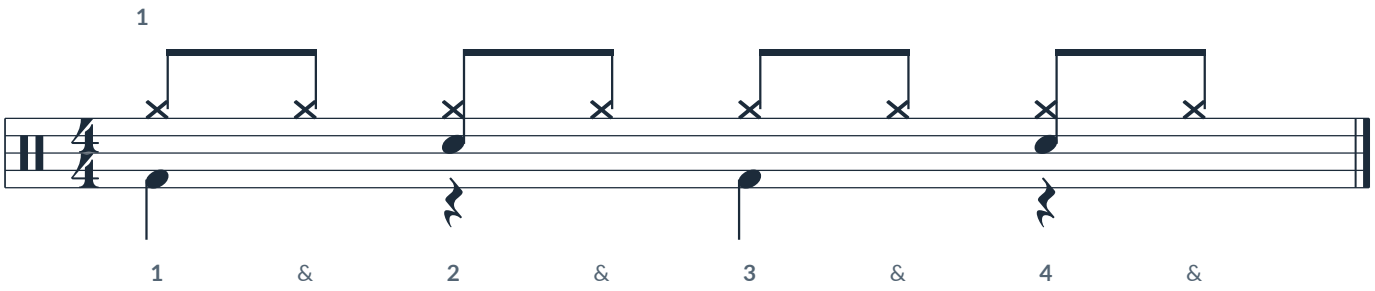
DAY 4 - KEEP IT MOVING

Divide each beat into two equal parts.

TODAY'S GOAL

Play eight even hi-hat notes in each four-beat bar.

CORE PATTERN



Count 1 & 2 & 3 & 4 &. Say "and" for &. The metronome clicks only on the numbers.

SEE > COUNT > CLAP > PLAY > GROOVE

1. **SEE** Each beam connects two eighth notes within one beat.
2. **COUNT** Say the numbers on the clicks and each "and" halfway between them.
3. **CLAP** Clap eight even sounds while the click still marks four beats.
4. **PLAY** Right hand: every number and &. Snare: 2 and 4. Kick: 1 and 3.
5. **GROOVE** Keep the tempo unchanged. You doubled the hi-hat notes, not the beat speed.

LISTEN FOR THIS

Listen for an even "number-and" pair. Do not squeeze the & too close to the next number.

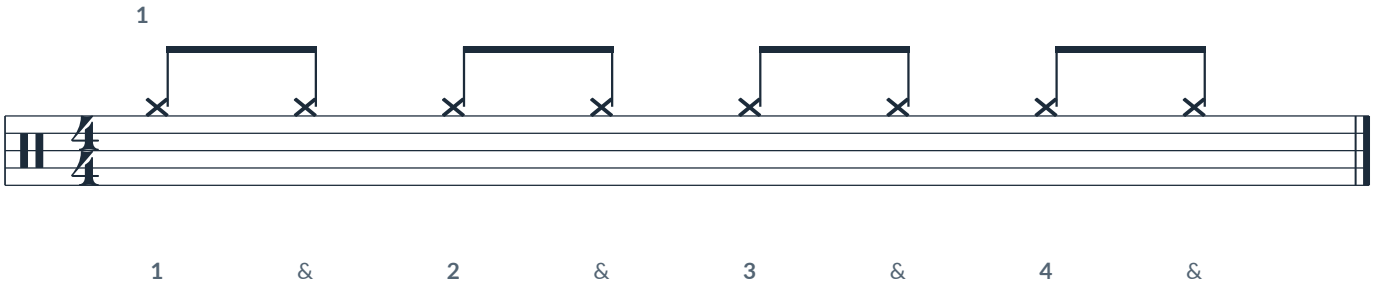
DAILY TARGET Play 16 bars at 60 BPM. An optional next target is 65-75 BPM.

DAY 4 | PAGE B | PRACTICE

DAY 4 - PUT IT INTO PRACTICE

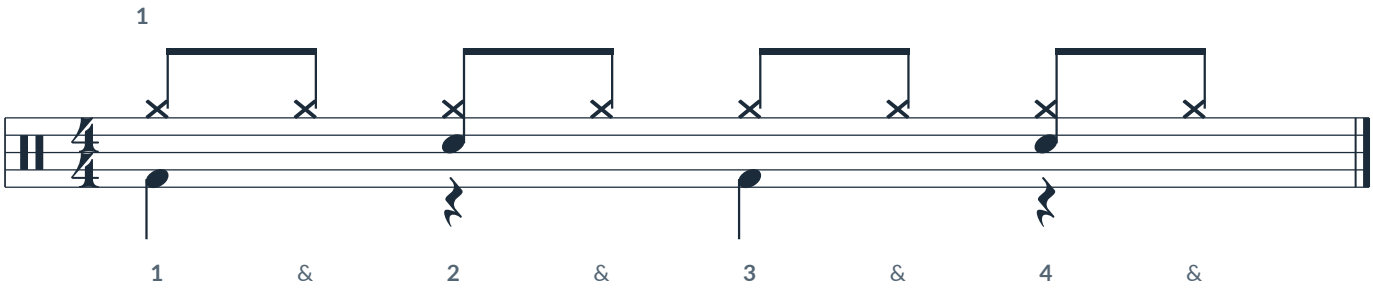
Start slowly. A clean repetition matters more than a higher tempo.

EXERCISE A | EVEN EIGHTHS, HAND ONLY



Play eight hi-hat notes per bar; leave snare and kick silent.

EXERCISE B | KEEP THE BACKBEAT IN PLACE



Keep all eight hi-hat notes. Add the snare and kick exactly as shown.

COMMON TRAP / QUICK FIX

In the hand voice, a snare note can share an eighth-note stem with the hi-hat. Strike it only once.

PRACTICE RECORD

Date: _____ Tempo: _____ BPM Clean bars: _____

Play 16 bars at 60 BPM. An optional next target is 65-75 BPM.

DAY 5 | PAGE A | LEARN

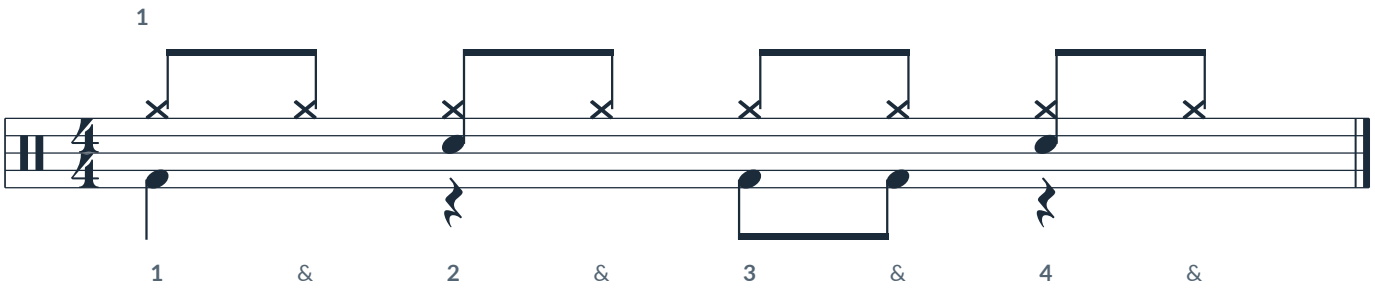
DAY 5 - MAKE IT YOURS

Keep the hands steady; change just one foot event.

TODAY'S GOAL

Add one extra kick on the & after beat 3.

CORE PATTERN



The two beamed kick notes fill beat 3: one on 3 and one on 3&. Beat 4 still has no kick.

SEE > COUNT > CLAP > PLAY > GROOVE

1. **SEE** Find the two low, down-stem eighth notes under 3 and its &.
2. **COUNT** Count all eighth notes, giving 3 and 3& exactly equal spacing.
3. **CLAP** Clap the kick rhythm on 1, 3 and 3& before using the pedal.
4. **PLAY** Keep hi-hat and snare unchanged. Add only the extra kick at 3&.
5. **GROOVE** Alternate four bars of the base groove and four bars of the variation.

LISTEN FOR THIS

Do not turn 3 and 3& into a rushed double hit. They must align with two separate hi-hat notes.

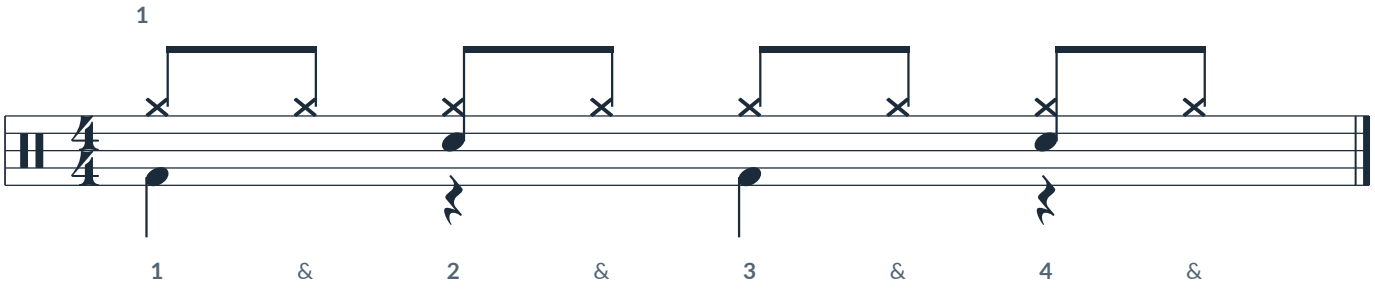
DAILY TARGET At 60 BPM, play 4 bars of A then 4 of B. Repeat the eight-bar block once.

DAY 5 | PAGE B | PRACTICE

DAY 5 - PUT IT INTO PRACTICE

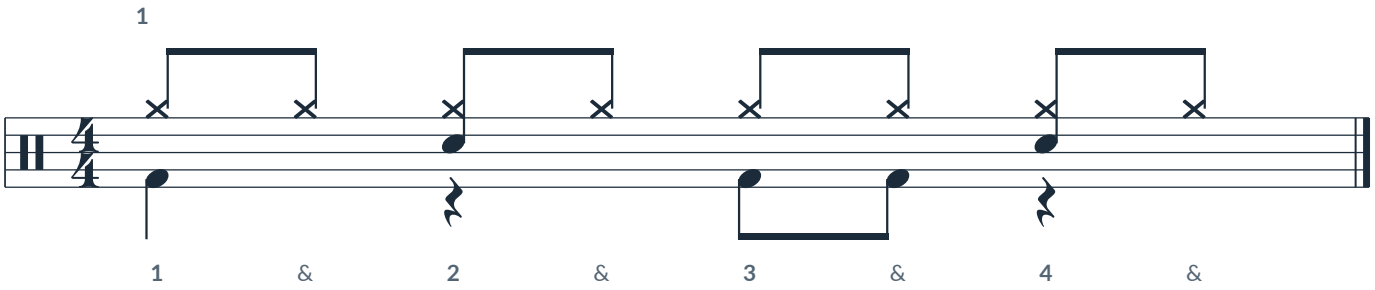
Start slowly. A clean repetition matters more than a higher tempo.

EXERCISE A | THE BASE GROOVE



Kick hits: 1 and 3. Play four bars; do not add any extra kick.

EXERCISE B | THE 3-AND VARIATION



Kick hits: 1, 3 and 3&. Play four bars with the same hands and tempo.

COMMON TRAP / QUICK FIX

The change is one added kick, not a faster groove. Return to A without stopping.

PRACTICE RECORD

Date: _____ Tempo: _____ BPM Clean bars: _____

At 60 BPM, play 4 bars of A then 4 of B. Repeat the eight-bar block once.

DAY 6 | PAGE A | LEARN

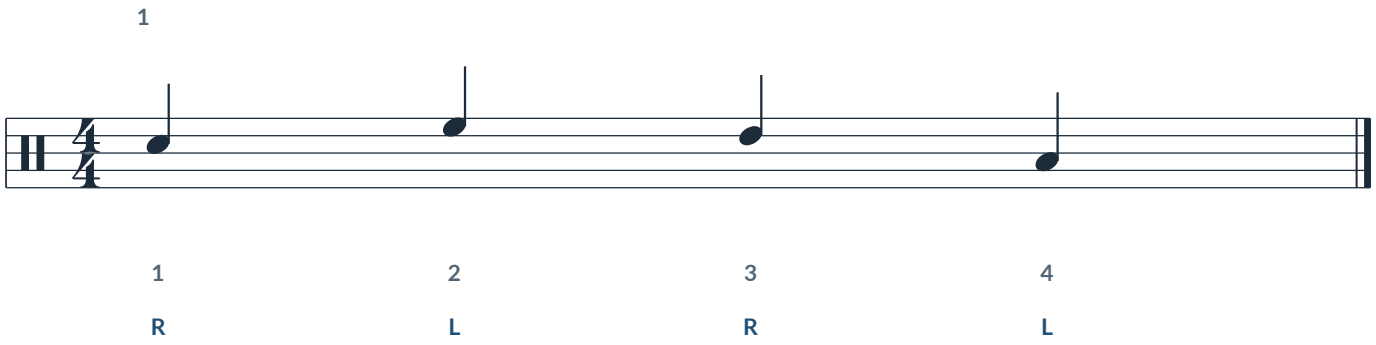
DAY 6 - PLAY YOUR FIRST FILL

Move around the pads without losing the four-beat bar.

TODAY'S GOAL

Play four quarter notes: Snare, Tom 1, Tom 2, Tom 3.

CORE PATTERN



One hit per beat. The four hits replace a groove bar; they do not add another bar.

SEE > COUNT > CLAP > PLAY > GROOVE

1. **SEE** Read the sequence: Snare on 1, Tom 1 on 2, Tom 2 on 3, Tom 3 on 4.
2. **COUNT** Say four steady counts; the next 1 is the start of the returning groove.
3. **CLAP** Clap four quarter notes, then another four, with no pause between bars.
4. **PLAY** Try R-L-R-L. Keep hi-hat and kick silent during this fill.
5. **GROOVE** After three groove bars, play the fill. Return on the very next beat 1.

LISTEN FOR THIS

Do not rush as your hands move to the toms. Aim for the center of each pad with relaxed strokes.

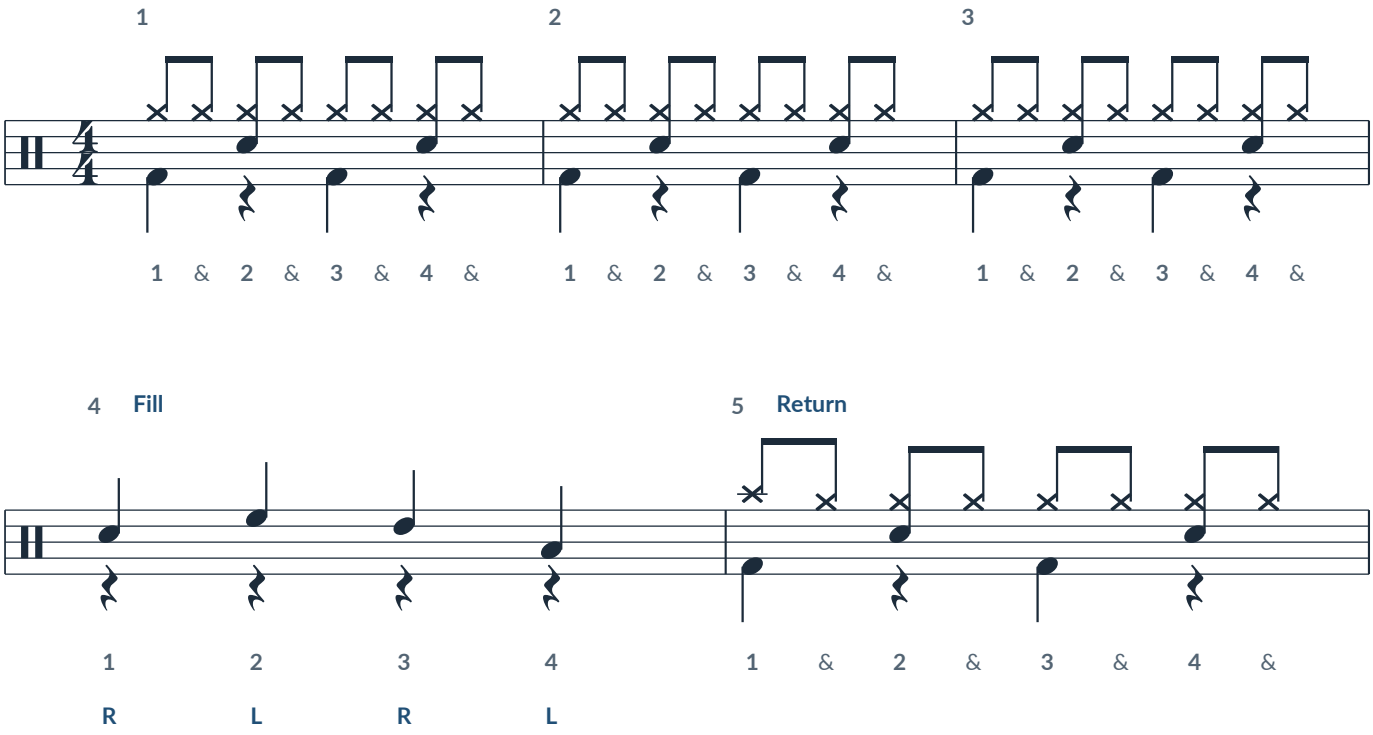
DAILY TARGET At 60 BPM, play 3 groove bars + 1 fill, then re-enter on time.

DAY 6 | PAGE B | PRACTICE

DAY 6 - PUT IT INTO PRACTICE

Start slowly. A clean repetition matters more than a higher tempo.

ONE CONTINUOUS PHRASE: 3 GROOVES + 1 FILL + THE RETURN



Bars 1-3: the basic groove. Bar 4: the four-note fill. Bar 5 begins the next phrase; it is shown so you can practice the landing.

RETURN TO THE GROOVE - DO NOT STOP

On the returning bar, play Crash + Kick on 1, then hi-hat on 1&. Snare stays on 2 and 4.

After bar 5, play two more groove bars, one fill, then another return. The cycle is four bars; the fifth written bar previews the next cycle.

PRACTICE RECORD

Date: _____ Tempo: _____ BPM Clean bars: _____

Pass when you can repeat the four-bar cycle 4 times and land on each new beat 1 at 60 BPM.

DAY 7 | PAGE A | LEARN

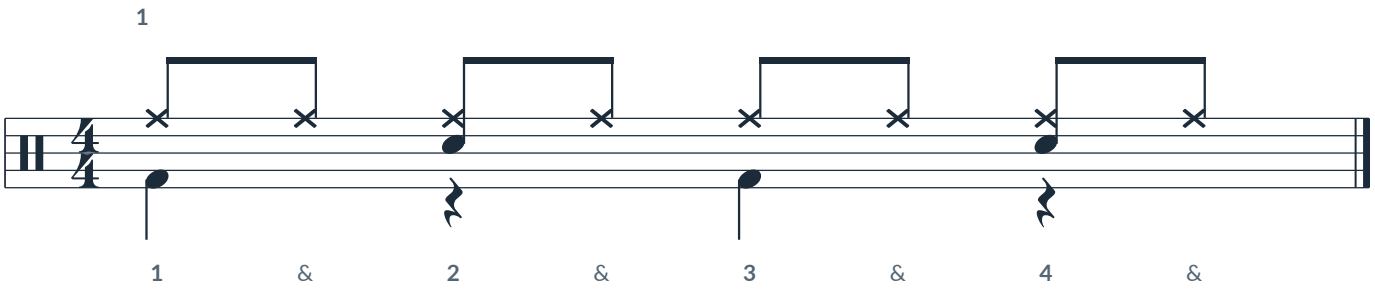
DAY 7 - PLAY YOUR FIRST SONG

Put the skills together in a 24-bar drum-only performance.

TODAY'S GOAL

Move your steady eighth notes to the ride, then learn a clear ending.

CORE PATTERN



Ride uses an X on the top line in this book. Hi-hat sits in the space above that line.

SEE > COUNT > CLAP > PLAY > GROOVE

1. **SEE** Compare the Ride and Hi-Hat positions in the key on page 2.
2. **COUNT** Keep counting 1 & 2 & 3 & 4 & through cymbal changes.
3. **CLAP** Review the backbeat on 2 and 4 before playing the ride groove.
4. **PLAY** Move only the right hand to Ride. Snare and Kick keep their existing pattern.
5. **GROOVE** Use the arrangement on page 17, then play bars 1-24 without restarting.

LISTEN FOR THIS

Changing cymbal does not change tempo. The last crash is on beat 1 of bar 24, not after the piece.

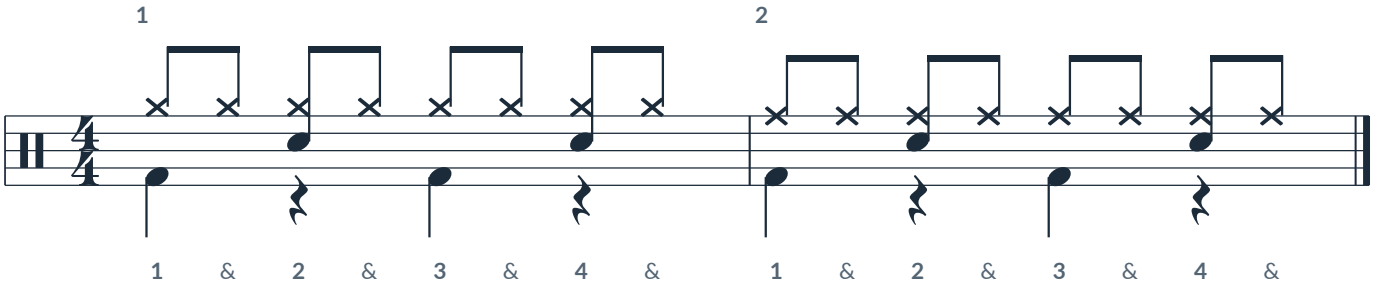
DAILY TARGET Complete all 24 bars at 60 BPM. Raise toward 80 BPM only when the whole piece stays steady.

DAY 7 | PAGE B | PRACTICE

DAY 7 - PUT IT INTO PRACTICE
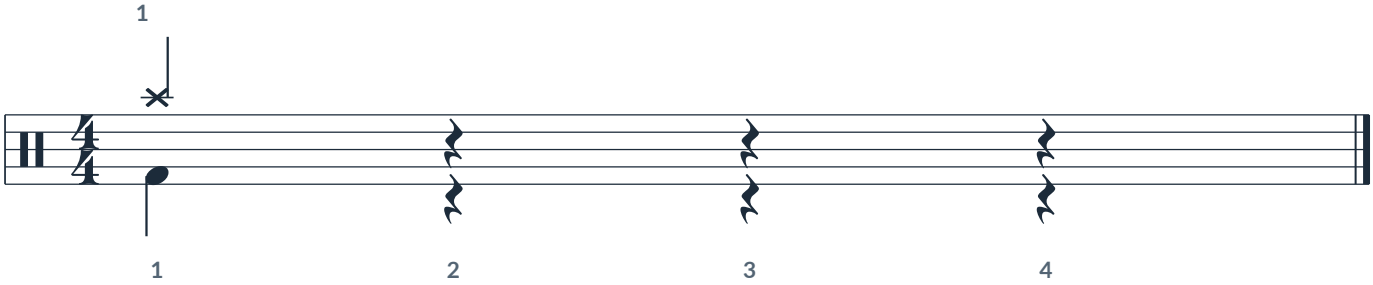
Start slowly. A clean repetition matters more than a higher tempo.

EXERCISE A | CHANGE CYMBAL ON THE BAR LINE



Bar 1: hi-hat groove. Bar 2: ride groove. Keep snare, kick and counting unchanged.

EXERCISE B | THE FINAL BAR



Crash + Kick on 1. No new hits on 2, 3 or 4; keep counting until the bar ends.

COMMON TRAP / QUICK FIX

Let the last cymbal decay naturally. The rests mean no new strikes here, not a required choke.

PRACTICE RECORD

Date: _____ Tempo: _____ BPM Clean bars: _____

Complete all 24 bars at 60 BPM. Raise toward 80 BPM only when the whole piece stays steady.

FINAL PERFORMANCE

YOUR 24-BAR ARRANGEMENT

A drum-only study using the skills from Days 1-7. No backing track is required.

BEFORE BAR 1

Set the metronome to 60 BPM, one click per quarter note. Count one silent bar: 1, 2, 3, 4. This count-in is NOT part of the 24 bars.

01-04	INTRO	Quarter-note Hi-Hat only. No Snare or Kick.
05-12	VERSE	Eight Hi-Hat hits per bar; Snare on 2/4; Kick on 1/3.
13-20	CHORUS	Move eighth notes to Ride. Keep Snare and Kick unchanged.
21	FILL	Snare -> Tom 1 -> Tom 2 -> Tom 3; one hit per beat.
22-23	OUTRO	Bar 22: Crash + Kick on 1; Hi-Hat resumes on 1&. Bar 23: basic groove.
24	ENDING	Crash + Kick on 1. Count 2, 3, 4 with no further hits.

THE FORM ADDS UP

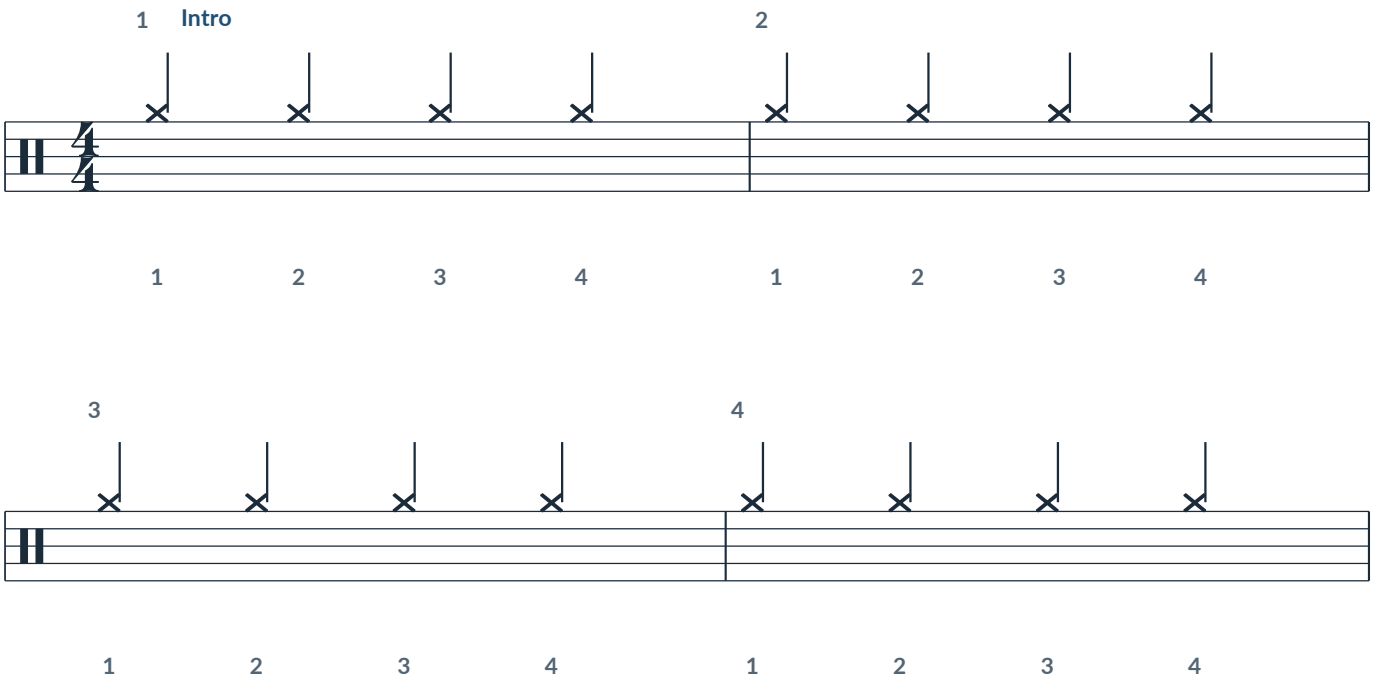
4 + 8 + 8 + 1 + 2 + 1 = 24 bars = 96 quarter-note beats. The repeated groove bars are intentional parts of the musical form.

During rehearsal, isolate a difficult bar and practice it slowly. During a complete run, keep counting after a missed hit and re-enter on the next beat 1.

FULL PERFORMANCE | BARS 1-4

YOUR COMPLETE SCORE | 01-04

All bars are written out. Continue across systems and page turns without adding pauses.



COUNT THE BARS, NOT JUST THE BEATS

Say "1-2-3-4, 2-2-3-4, 3-2-3-4, 4-2-3-4" to track the intro. These changing first numbers count bars; the pulse stays the same.

BEFORE YOU CONTINUE

Prepare the Snare and Kick for bar 5. Do not add a fill at the end of bar 4.

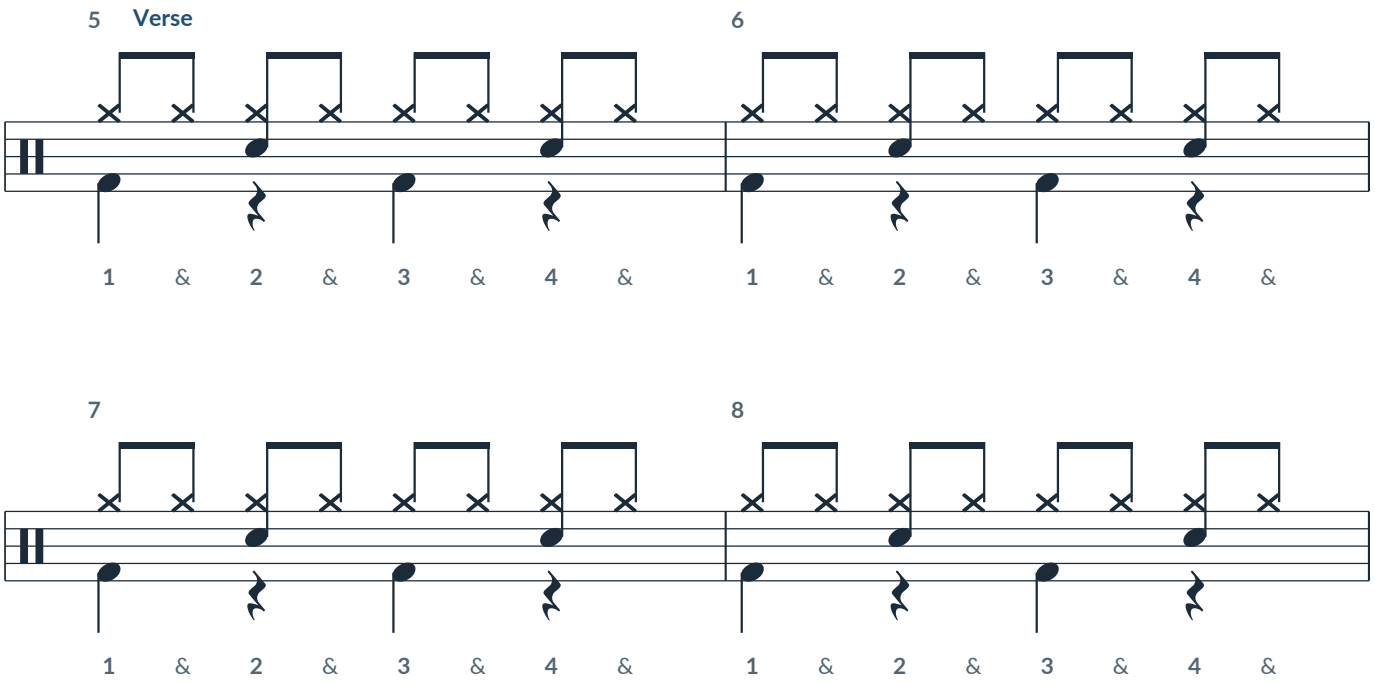
PRACTICE CHECK

Keep the pulse. Count the bar lines. Match the written instruments. Continue without an extra beat.

FULL PERFORMANCE | BARS 5-8

YOUR COMPLETE SCORE | 05-08

All bars are written out. Continue across systems and page turns without adding pauses.



KEEP THE BACKBEAT STEADY

The Hi-Hat now plays on every number and every &. Snare still falls on 2 and 4; Kick still falls on 1 and 3.

BEFORE YOU CONTINUE

Bars 5-8 are the first half of the verse. Keep playing into bar 9 without restarting.

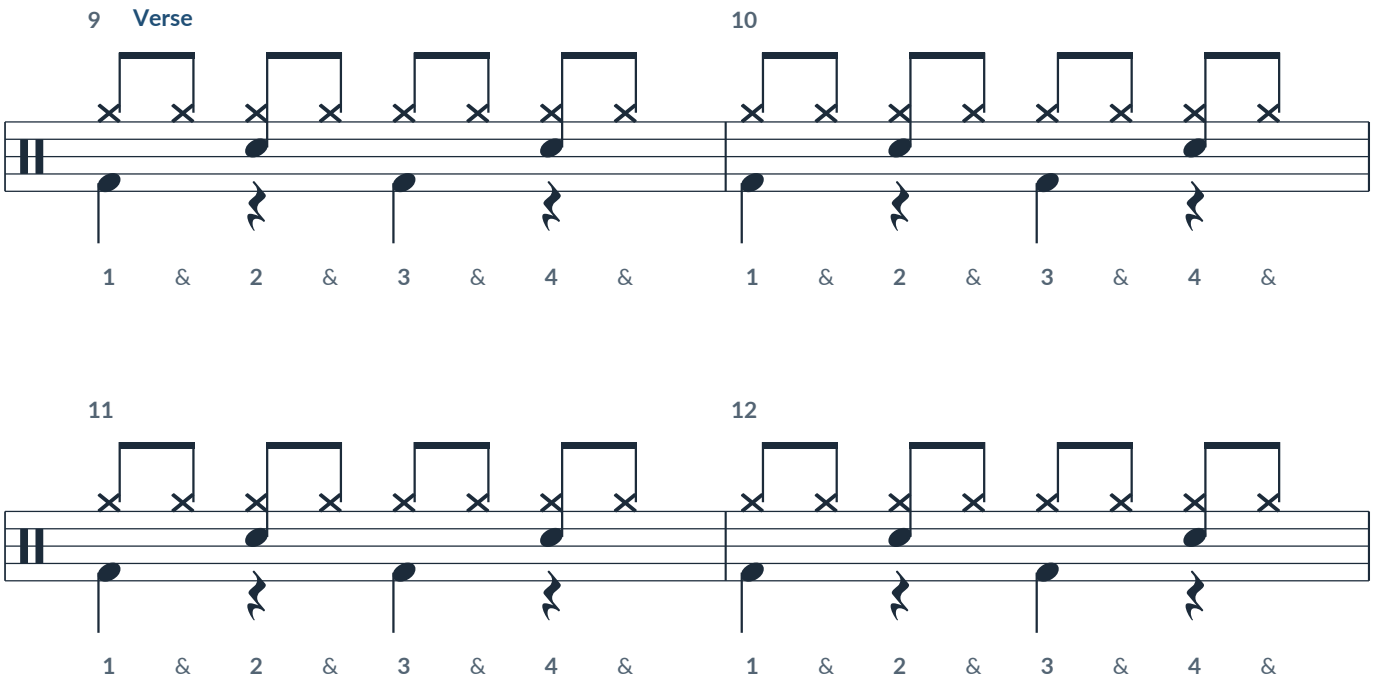
PRACTICE CHECK

Keep the pulse. Count the bar lines. Match the written instruments. Continue without an extra beat.

FULL PERFORMANCE | BARS 9-12

YOUR COMPLETE SCORE | 09-12

All bars are written out. Continue across systems and page turns without adding pauses.



HOLD THE SAME GROOVE

These four bars continue the verse. They are written out intentionally so the full 24-bar performance remains easy to follow.

BEFORE YOU CONTINUE

Finish bar 12 on Hi-Hat. Move the right hand to Ride for beat 1 of bar 13.

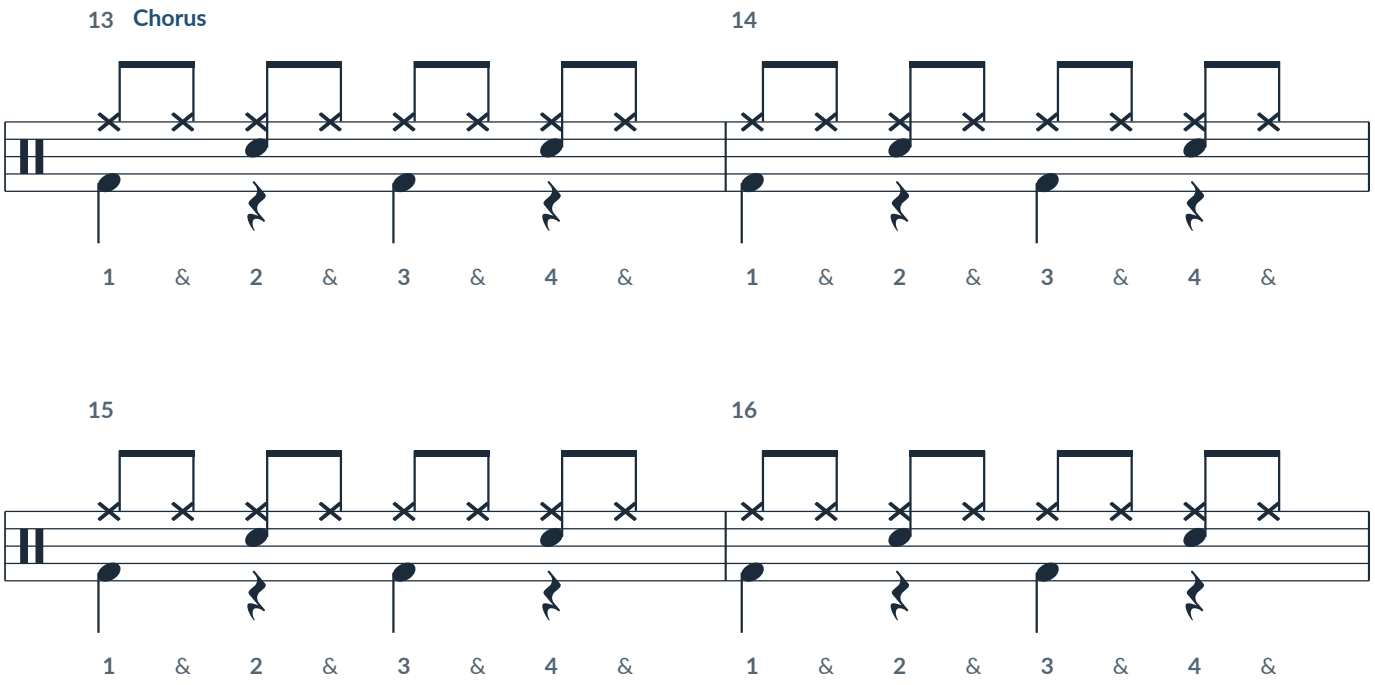
PRACTICE CHECK

Keep the pulse. Count the bar lines. Match the written instruments. Continue without an extra beat.

FULL PERFORMANCE | BARS 13-16

YOUR COMPLETE SCORE | 13-16

All bars are written out. Continue across systems and page turns without adding pauses.



CHANGE THE CYMBAL, NOT THE PULSE

Ride notes sit on the top staff line. Compare this with the Hi-Hat space above the staff on the previous page.

BEFORE YOU CONTINUE

Use the same eighth-note spacing. Do not add a Crash at bar 13; the written pattern starts on Ride.

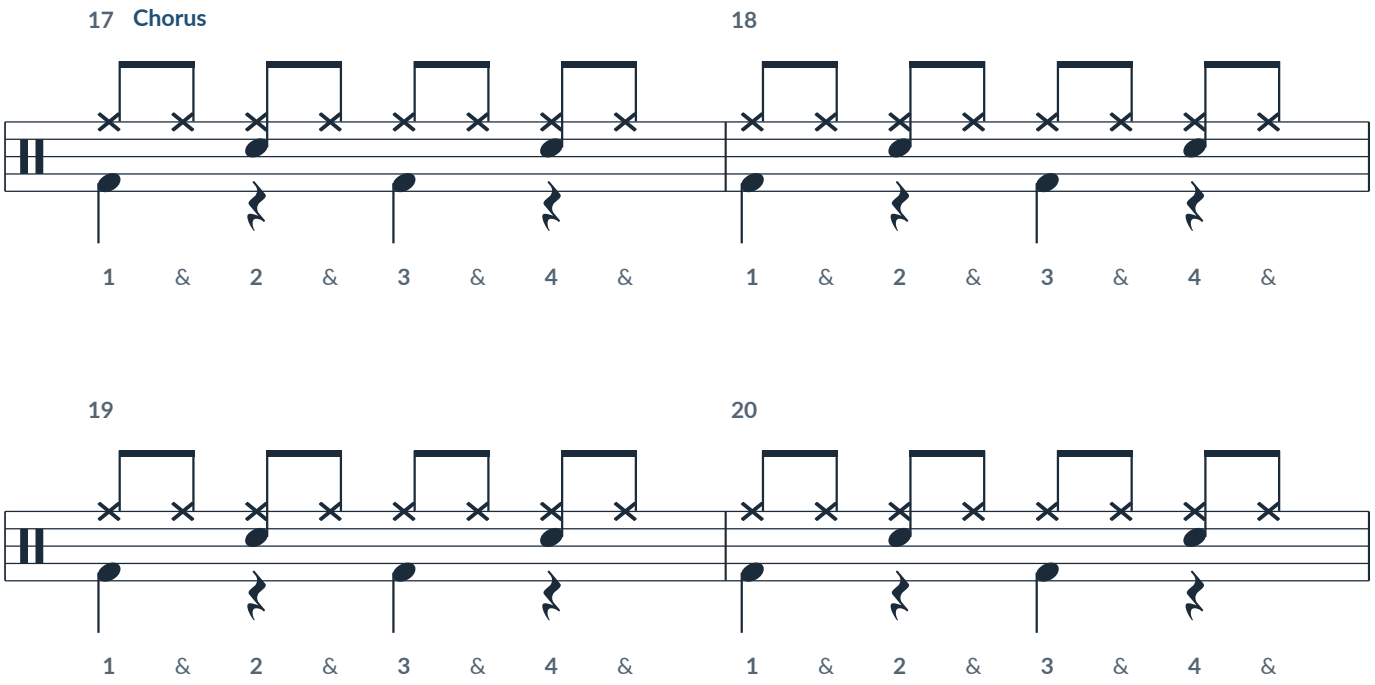
PRACTICE CHECK

Keep the pulse. Count the bar lines. Match the written instruments. Continue without an extra beat.

FULL PERFORMANCE | BARS 17-20

YOUR COMPLETE SCORE | 17-20

All bars are written out. Continue across systems and page turns without adding pauses.



PREPARE THE FILL

Keep the Ride groove through the end of bar 20. The fill begins at bar 21, beat 1, not early on beat 4 of bar 20.

BEFORE YOU CONTINUE

Count through bar 20. Then play Snare, Tom 1, Tom 2 and Tom 3 at the same tempo.

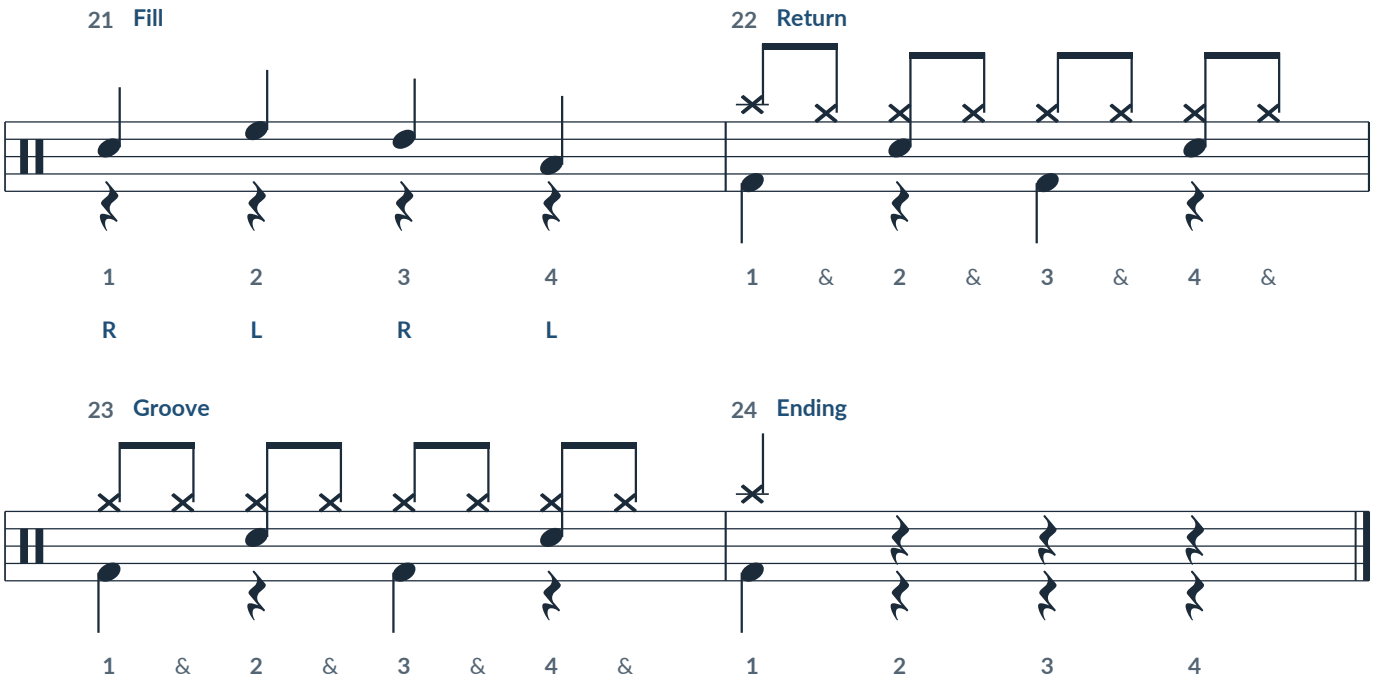
PRACTICE CHECK

Keep the pulse. Count the bar lines. Match the written instruments. Continue without an extra beat.

FULL PERFORMANCE | BARS 21-24

YOUR COMPLETE SCORE | 21-24

All bars are written out. Continue across systems and page turns without adding pauses.



LAND, CONTINUE, THEN FINISH

Bar 21 is the fill. Bar 22 starts with Crash + Kick, then returns to Hi-Hat on 1&. Bar 23 keeps the groove moving.

FINISH THE LAST BAR

Bar 24: play Crash + Kick on 1, then count 2, 3, 4 without new hits. Let the cymbal decay; end at the final bar line.

PRACTICE CHECK

Keep the pulse. Count the bar lines. Match the written instruments. Continue without an extra beat.

COMPLETE YOUR FIRST WEEK

7-DAY DRUM CHALLENGE

Completing the week is a starting point, not a deadline or a claim of mastery.

Record the tempo at which each skill is steady. Repeat any day that needs more time. Clean timing and relaxed movement come first.

☐ **DAY 1**	16 bars of steady quarter-note Hi-Hat.	_____ BPM
☐ **DAY 2**	8 bars with Snare on 2 and 4.	_____ BPM
☐ **DAY 3**	16 bars with Kick on 1 and 3.	_____ BPM
☐ **DAY 4**	16 bars of even eighth-note Hi-Hat.	_____ BPM
☐ **DAY 5**	4 bars of A + 4 bars of B, repeated once.	_____ BPM
☐ **DAY 6**	Four groove/fill cycles with an on-time return.	_____ BPM
☐ **DAY 7**	All 24 bars, including the final three rests.	_____ BPM

Name: _____ **Date:** _____

KEEP PLAYING. KEEP GROWING.

Build on the same method: see the pattern, count it, clap it, play it, then make it groove. For setup questions, contact cs@aklot.com.

Editorial basis: AKLOT Rhythm Handbook (user-supplied) and the prior 24-page course. Notation conventions checked against Drumeo, *How to Read Drum Music*, and Vic Firth / Mark Wessels, *A Fresh Approach to the Drumset*, notation reference pp. 106-107. Exercise music is re-engraved for this course, not copied from those external examples.